

Aparna Vannam
Technical Writer
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Summary:

- Detail-oriented and highly skilled Technical Content Writer with around 5 years of experience in creating, migrating, and managing comprehensive product documentation for various industries.
- Proficient in using Atlassian Confluence, SharePoint, Azure DevOps and other wiki tools for developing user-friendly and accessible documentation.
- Proficient in developing user guides, API documentation, release notes, and online help systems.
- Skilled in using a variety of content management tools, including Atlassian Confluence, MadCap Flare, and Adobe FrameMaker.
- Adept at collaborating with cross-functional teams to ensure that documentation meets the needs of both technical and non-technical audiences.
- Proficient in using Git and Markdown for version control and content formatting, ensuring high-quality, user-friendly documentation that meets organizational goals.
- Expertise includes creating clear, concise, and user-friendly documentation for all stages of the SDLC, from requirements gathering to design, implementation, testing, deployment, and maintenance.
- Collaborated with subject matter experts (SMEs) to research, gather, and translate technical information into user-friendly documentation.
- Specialized in API documentation, release notes, and structured content creation using DITA, XML, and industry-leading tools like Madcap Flare and DITA toolkit. Proficient in documenting and testing APIs using Postman and Swagger.
- Proven expertise in SharePoint administration, supporting organizational needs through effective content management, site administration, and workflow optimization.
- Have flexibility and ability to learn and use new technologies and to work in a team environment as well as independently to get things done.
- Developed and implemented documentation style guides, templates, and best practices to standardize content and improve consistency.
- Determined clearest and most logical way to present information for greatest reader comprehension.
- Strong writing and desktop editing skills, checking for clarity and consistency in grammar and style and proofreading.
- Expertized in planning and developing standard operating procedure manuals (SOP).
- Ability to produce high quality requirement specifications to support functional design development.
- Hands on experiences with various user tools and internal portal to help to understand and generate User guide and functionality documentation.

Skills:

Documentation Tools: Atlassian Confluence, MadCap Flare, Adobe FrameMaker, Microsoft Word, Google Docs, MS Visio, iGrafx, Adobe InDesign, Microsoft Excel, Microsoft PowerPoint, Microsoft Visual Studio Code

Content Management: Azure DevOps, SharePoint, CMS Platforms

Technical Writing: API documentation, User Manuals, Installation Guides, Release Notes

Other Tools: JIRA, Git, Markdown

Web Technologies: XML, HTML

Reporting Tools: Tableau, SSRS, MS Access, Pivot Reports, Power BI

Languages: SQL Server, T-SQL, PL-SQL, Python and HTML

Project Methodologies: Agile and Waterfall

Summary of Experience:

Client: USAA,

Aug 2020 – Feb 2023

San Antonio, TX

The United Services Automobile Association (USAA) is a San Antonio-based Fortune 500 provides insurance, banking, investments, retirement products. Analyze competitiveness of USAA Property & Casualty business which helps business in getting actionable insights from data to remain competitive in the market.

Responsibilities:

- Collaborated with product managers, engineers, and UX/UI designers to gather information and create detailed user guides, release notes, and FAQs.
- Managed Confluence spaces at an administrative level, including setting up and maintaining space permissions, templates, and workflows to streamline documentation processes.
- Used Visual Studio Code (VS Code) for efficient editing of documentation, including code snippets, Markdown files, and technical content, streamlining the process of writing and updating developer documentation.
- Examined existing PCM workflow processes and then documented each process in a diagram format on Adobe Illustrator.
- Used Flare's integration with tools like Git or Microsoft Team Foundation Server to manage content changes and collaborate with other writers.
- Utilized XML to structure content within DITA frameworks, improving content reuse and modularity across various publications and delivery formats.
- Used HTML to customize the layout of documentation pages and ensure content was accessible, readable, and responsive across platforms.
- Used DITA to structure documentation for scalability and reuse across different formats (PDF, HTML, and online help systems).
- Led the creation of detailed API documentation for multiple internal tools, focusing on clarity, accuracy, and ease of use for both developers and end-users.
- Played a key role in migrating legacy documentation from internal systems to Confluence, improving searchability and version control.
- Directed the migration of legacy content into a DITA-based system, streamlining content management and improving documentation consistency and reusability across various platforms.
- Integrated Markdown and HTML to deliver well-formatted, clean documentation that aligns with design standards and enhances readability.
- Produced clear, structured documentation for APIs, SDKs, and other technical integrations, leveraging tools like Postman.
- Utilized Git for version control to manage updates to documentation, track changes, and collaborate with development teams in an Agile environment.
- Utilized Markdown for writing and formatting documentation, enabling easy conversion and compatibility with various platforms.

- Created and maintained content in content management systems like Confluence and Microsoft Azure DevOps ensuring all documents were up-to-date and easily accessible to team members and end-users.
- Conducted user research to understand documentation needs and iterated on content to enhance user experience.
- Created comprehensive and user-friendly release notes for software updates, outlining features, improvements, and bug fixes, significantly improving communication with users.
- Created and delivered training materials and sessions for internal teams on best practices for using SharePoint and technical documentation processes.
- Created detailed documentation for each SDLC phase, including requirements analysis, design specifications, development standards, test plans, deployment procedures, and maintenance protocols.
- Administered and managed multiple SharePoint sites including site creation, permissions, and content organization, resulting in improved team collaboration and document accessibility.

Client: USAA,

July 2019 – Sept 2019

San Antonio, TX

Worked on validating, developing, editing documents for Learning and development, Risk and Compliance, IT and other CoSA and standardizing all documents as per the USAA format. Managed all related documents on the company's site.

Responsibilities:

- Involved in transferring existing documentation from one platform or format to another and creating new content to support products.
- Integrated with Subject Matter Experts in the business to identify, assess and aggregate the available documents.
- Worked on gathering business requirements from product owners and converting those into functional requirement documents for development teams with technical requirements, workflow, and business logic and use case diagrams.
- Created custom site columns and content types based on Content Type hierarchy and used them in list and document libraries.
- Edited and incorporated team-member comments and changes to the specification documentation, resulting in a draft specification for submission.
- Edited, standardized, or made changes to material prepared by other writers or establishment personnel.
- Collaborated with marketing and support teams to ensure consistent messaging and branding across all customer-facing documentation.
- Administered Confluence spaces, including creating and managing spaces, pages, and user permissions to support various documentation projects.
- Implemented content organization strategies within Confluence, improving navigation and user access to critical information.
- Managed the end-to-end process of creating technical documentation, including API documentation, system architecture guides, and process workflows.
- Worked with system engineers, software engineers, and program management to translate technical information into clear, concise documentation to include user manuals.

- Created and managed technical documentation for a suite of enterprise software products, including installation guides, system administration manuals, and release notes.
- Played a key role in the migration of documentation from legacy systems to a modern, wiki-based platform, enhancing searchability and collaboration.
- Followed the Document Development Life Cycle (DDLC) to develop well-structured and information rich documents.
- Included Resources and References to additional documentation, whitepapers, best practice guides, and official training resources provided by the cloud service providers.
- Prepared process maps and supporting documents demonstrating data flow in the data lifecycle.

EC Council

May 2014 – June 2015

Hyderabad, India,

EC Council cyber security technical certification body. It provides Online Certification courses like Certified Ethical Hacking (CEH), Certified Chief Information Security Officer (CCISO), Master of Security Science (MSS), Security in Cloud Computing etc.

Responsibilities:

- Performed research on a topic, created outline, gathered information, and developed documentation for the topics given in the outline.
- Developed Documentation for ASPEN application and tested application for internal and external users' profile.
- Worked on gathering business and created functional requirement documents for development teams with technical requirements, workflow, and business logic and use case diagrams.
- During migration period, created JIRA tickets and wrote user stories, user acceptance criteria and followed up with the team to maintain their status.
- Ensured all documents created or updated by the IT team are clear, concise, professional, and correct before publishing it.
- Gathered or developed pictures, diagrams, charts, sketches etc., to support the written information in pictorial form.
- Developed Documentation, Installation Guides, release notes, User Guides for the designated audience.
- Documented the dos and don'ts in cyber security, creating & maintaining passwords.
- Developed marketing material and advertised the product to boost sales.
- Researched on the latest Computer Hacking and Security Concepts relevant to the above-mentioned projects.
- Edited the technical documents after the release of new versions of the IT network & security certification courses.
- Downloaded trial versions of ethical hacking tools for security auditing and prepared documents for step by step working of the tools along with the screenshots.
- Performed market research analysis for a competitive product.

Shreenidhi Green Services

June 2013 – April 2014

India,

Responsibilities:

- Worked with innovation team to prepare documentation required for Patent.
- Converted the final draft of patent description from Microsoft word to pdf format.
- Compiled all documents, patent forms and submitted to Federal government office, India.
- Organized and participated in company's stall in industrial Expo which included enrollment for stall, arranging for product pamphlets, business cards, printing flexes, greeting visitors, providing product details.
- Used Adobe InDesign prepared flyers for marketing team.
- Gathered functional, business, and technical requirements using individual and group meetings.
- Prepared charts, graphs, or forms to go along with business and technical requirements.
- Performed research on a topic, created outline, gathered information, and developed documentation for the topics given in the outline.
- Proofread the document before presenting it to higher authorities.

Education:

Bachelor's Degree in Engineering from Pune University, India.

May 2013